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In days at Brown, anger, frustration

Those who knew suspected shooter say he felt classes were too easy and apparently left with hard feelings

By Lea Skene, John Hilliard, Sean Cotter, Marcela Rodrigues, Mariana Simões, Laura Crimaldi, Christopher Gavin, Steph Machado, and Shelley Murphy of the Globe staff. The story was written by Skene.

Growing up in Portugal, Claudio Manuel Neves Valente stood out for his intellectual potential. In high school, he traveled to national and international physics competitions. He later graduated from Portugal's top

university for science and engineering.

But when he moved to the United States in 2000 to pursue a doctorate in physics at Brown University, his colleagues experienced an ill-tempered young man who felt that even an American Ivy League college was no match for his own intellect. Neves Valente complained the classes were too easy and left the school months after enrolling, apparently with hard feelings.

The timeline

Surveillance cameras played a key role in the protracted hunt for the shooter. **A5.**

Reddit's tips

Investigators credited a post for aiding the probe, marking a sharp distinction from the platform's infamous role in the Marathon bombing. **D1.**

"He could be kind and gentle, though he often became frustrated — sometimes angry — about courses, professors, and living conditions," said Scott Watson, a Syracuse University physics professor who befriended Neves Valente at Brown.

After authorities linked him to the mass shooting on Brown's campus and the killing of an MIT professor earlier this week, Neves Valente, 48, was found dead by suicide Thursday night. In the immediate aftermath, a

fuller picture of the suspect emerged: of a brilliant student whose academic promise seemed to dissipate abruptly, an angry genius with long-simmering resentment, a loner who painstakingly planned and executed extraordinary violence.

His death ended a frantic manhunt that began following the Brown shooting Saturday afternoon, according to police. He entered a storage unit in southern New Hampshire **INVESTIGATION, Page A7**



ELLA COOK

MUKHAMMAZAZIZ UMURZOKOV

CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

A memorial continued to grow on the Brown University campus on Friday.



COLLEGE REPUBLICANS OF AMERICA

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

In the days since the deadly mass shooting at Brown University, some have portrayed Ella Cook as a staunch partisan, a conservative crusader on a campus of liberals.

Her friends remember her for something much simpler: "carpet time" on her dorm room floor. "Carpet time" was exactly what it sounded like. Students sprawled on the white rug in her pastel bedroom, chatting or doing homework. Everyone was welcome, so long as they first sang a song into the karaoke mic. In return, they got the comfort of Cook's company, her kind smile, and her quiet faith.

Cook, a 19-year-old sophomore from Alabama, was killed last week when a gunman slipped into an unlocked building and opened fire on a review session. Another student died, and nine others were wounded.

The search for the gunman came to a dramatic end on Thursday when the suspect, also accused of murdering an MIT professor, was found dead in

COOK, Page A6

Two lives full of promise, cut short in a horrifying instant

Both remembered for their achievements and so much more



UMURZOKOV FAMILY

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

Growing up, MukhammadAziz Umurzokov would spend hours analyzing scans of his own spinal cord — scrutinizing his nerves, his disks, his bones, noticing how they shifted after the surgery that changed his life.

Umurzokov was 7 when he was diagnosed with Chiari malformation and met Dr. Jeffrey Wisoff. The neurosurgeon removed a small piece of the back of Umurzokov's skull to restore normal flow of spinal fluid, and, in the process, led Umurzokov to his dream of becoming a doctor. From then on, Umurzokov wanted to help other children suffering from neurological conditions like his.

The pair lost touch over the years, but they never forgot each other. In August, before moving into his dorm at Brown University, Umurzokov sent Wisoff an email asking to reconnect. The two decided to meet in New York in the new year, to discuss Umurzokov's future career in medicine.

Their meeting will never happen, and Umurzokov will never perform surgery. On Dec. 13, with

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Dec.ent

Saturday: Sun's back, nippy. High 38-43. Low 32-37.

Sunday: Warmer but windy. High 44-49. Low 22-27.

Weather and Comics, D4-5.

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The Justice Department released thousands of files about Jeffrey Epstein but the incomplete document dump did not seem to break significant ground. **A2.**

Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. is targeting Lyme disease, saying the Trump administration plans to fight it aggressively. **B1.**

The administration said it may shift its response to childhood vaccines. **A10.**

Deadline will pass, but ACA talks aren't dead

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The Dec. 31 deadline to extend enhanced Obamacare health insurance tax credits has loomed over Congress for months, sparking this fall's record-long government shutdown and dominating legislative efforts in the final days of the year.

Now, lawmakers are leaving town for the holidays without taking action. That guarantees

the tax credits will expire for about 22 million Americans on New Year's Day, causing huge increases in their monthly premiums that are expected to lead many of them to drop their coverage.

"As I've said over and over again, the toothpaste is out of the tube," House minority leader Chuck Schumer, a New York Democrat, said this week. "January 1, it expires. Once that happens, millions will be without

health care."

But it's not as completely hopeless as Schumer implied, if Congress can act to extend the credits in early 2026.

Bipartisan groups of lawmakers have promised to continue working on an extension, and there were glimmers of hope this week that a compromise could be reached on what has become a new flashpoint in the divisive, long-running health care debate.

"Yes, we want to deal with this before the tax credits expire, but I'm certainly not going to say, 'Oh well, we missed the deadline, there's nothing we can do now,'" said Representative Kevin Kiley, a California Republican who has been part of a bipartisan group of House lawmakers working to craft an extension.

The same type of talks is happening among rank-and-file **ACA, Page A10**